



France



Café culture

In French, *café* means “coffee.” While this Paris *café* is known for the artists and thinkers who met to discuss their ideas, most people simply drink and watch the world go by.



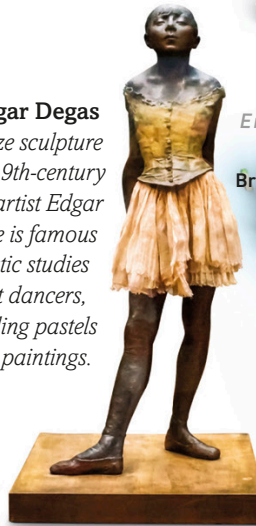
Tour de France

This grueling annual bicycle race was first held in 1903. It is made up of 21 stages over three weeks and covers 2,200 miles (3,500 km).



Edgar Degas

This bronze sculpture is by the 19th-century French artist Edgar Degas. He is famous for realistic studies of ballet dancers, including pastels and paintings.



English Channel

UNITED KINGDOM

Paris lies on the Seine River in northern France.



At the end of each stage, the rider with the fastest overall time since the race began gets to wear a yellow jersey.

Château de Chambord

Built in the 16th century as a royal hunting lodge, this *château*, near Orléans, has more than 400 rooms. *Châteaux* such as this are the historic residences of France's nobility.



France is the **largest nation** in western Europe. The mainland is known as “the **Hexagon**,” while its **island of Corsica** was the birthplace of **Napoleon**, a famous leader. The capital, **Paris**, welcomes **20 million visitors** every year.



- 📏 248,573 sq miles (643,801 sq km)
- 👤 67.8 million
- ★ Paris
- 🗣️ French, other languages (+5)